# HIRING MANAGER RECRUITING PROCESS

A guide for hiring managers on AAP and API's recruiting process — from identifying a hiring need to extending an offer.

**Purpose of This Guide**

This guide outlines the steps hiring managers should follow to support a consistent, fair, and professional recruiting process at AAP and API. Whether you are requesting a new position or filling an existing vacancy, this resource is intended to help ensure proper approvals, documentation, collaboration, and candidate experience from start to finish.

**Who this is for:** Hiring managers and department leaders involved in requesting, interviewing, and selecting candidates.

**Use this guide when:** Requesting a new position or filling an existing vacancy.

## 1. Identify Hiring Need

**Goal:** Confirm the hiring need, position type, and budget.

**Steps:**
- Review team workload, department structure, and organizational goals.
- Determine whether the need is for a **new position** or a **backfill**.

**New Position (newly created role)**
- Identify the business justification.
- Confirm pay band, budget, and obtain manager/leadership approval.

**Backfill (replacing a previous employee)**
- Confirm reason for vacancy.
- Ensure the position is still needed at the same level.

## 2. Submit Job Requisition or Backfill Request

**Goal:** Provide HR with complete position details for review and posting.

**New Role / Position:**
- Define the job title, department, and manager.
- Identify key qualifications and responsibilities.
- Complete the Recruitment Requisition Form.

**Backfill of Previous Position:**
- Review and update the job description if responsibilities have changed.
- Complete the Recruitment Requisition Form.

## 3. Collaborate on Job Posting

**Goal:** Finalize the job posting, determine posting locations, interview plans, and reporting.

**Steps:**

- Partner with HR to refine and finalize the job posting language.
- HR will submit the finalized posting to the VP of Marketing for required branding, tone, and organizational messaging approval.
- Determine posting strategy (external job boards, niche sites, or internal-only).
- Identify posting collaborators (HR, team leads or other designated staff) and confirm each person's role in approvals, applicant screening, and interview participation.
- Confirm interview format (phone, video, in-person), panel members (if applicable), and expected timeline for reviewing applicants.
- Align with HR on who will coordinate interview scheduling to ensure smooth candidate experience.
- HR will publish the approved posting to the appropriate job boards and internal platforms.
- The hiring manager and designated collaborators will receive a notification once the posting is live.

**External Job Posting**
When posted externally, positions will automatically appear on:

- BambooHR
- Indeed
- Glassdoor
- ZipRecruiter
- RxAAP.com Employment Opportunities

If you would like it to be advertised on any additional sites or resources, contact HR.

**Internal Job Posting**
If posted internally:

- HR will publish the job on the Careers Website only.
- External applicants may still appear if links circulate online or are shared by employees.
- Due to this, an internal-only posting cannot be guaranteed to receive only internal applicants.

## 4. Review Applicants

**Goal:** Screen and shortlist qualified candidates using consistent, compliant criteria.

**Steps**

- Review resumes and applications based on defined qualifications.
- Evaluate experience, skills, and cultural fit.
- Shortlist candidates for interviews.
- Document reasons for shortlisting or rejecting applicants.
- Use STAR ratings and comments in BambooHR to support your assessment and ensure compliance.
  - Using STAR ratings is optional but highly recommended for maintaining consistency across candidate reviews. See the STAR Rating Reference Guide for suggested guidance on how to apply ratings effectively.

**In BambooHR**

Path: **Hiring > Job Openings > [Your Position] > Candidates**

- Candidates who apply will appear under the Candidates tab.
- All applicants automatically receive an acknowledgment email.
- Click a candidate's name to view their full profile, resume, and application.
- Update their status using the **status** drop-down menu.
- All **Active** and **Disqualified** status changes must include comments.
  - Comments notify HR and collaborators.

**Active Statuses (Still in consideration)**

(Be sure to add a comment)

- Reviewed
- Schedule phone/video interview
- Schedule in-person interview
- Put on hold

**Disqualified Statuses**

(Be sure to add factual, job-related comments)

- Not qualified
- Overqualified
- Not a fit

**Important:**
Do not use **Move Candidate** or **Delete Candidate** functions.

## 5. Interviewing Guidelines (Reference)

**Goal:** Conduct consistent, fair, and job-related interviews while collecting documented feedback.

Important: Refer to the AAP/API Interview Guidelines document for full instructions, required forms, and prohibited topics.

**Key expectations (summary)**

- Use structured, job-related questions and take job-related notes.
- For panel interviews:
  - Each panel member takes notes independently.
  - Do not discuss ratings until after the candidate leaves.
  - Each panel member completes an Interview Evaluation Form separately.
- After the interview:
  - Each interviewer completes an evaluation with numeric ratings and job-related comments.
  - If submitted online, the evaluation is automatically sent to the Hiring Manager and HR and retained in the candidate's file for documentation and compliance.
  - If completed on paper, submit the evaluation to the Hiring Manager and HR for secure retention in the candidate's file.
  - Document candidate status and outcomes in BambooHR.

**Interview Evaluation Form:** A copy is included in the Interview Guidelines document. To complete and submit online, use the Interview Evaluation Form link.

## 6. Job Offer Process

**Goal:** Ensure a smooth, timely, and professional offer experience.

**Steps**

1. **Change Candidate Status**
   - Once a final candidate is selected, update the status to "**Candidate Selected for Hire**."
   - Add a brief justification in the Comments section (e.g., "Selected based on strong interview performance and required experience.")
   - This triggers HR's internal **Hiring/Reporting Workflow**

2. **Review Verbal Offer Guidelines**
   Before extending a verbal offer, the Hiring Manager must review the Verbal Offer Guidelines to ensure the conversation is:
   - Consistent across all candidates
   - Professional in tone and delivery
   - Compliant with hiring policies and employment laws
   - Aligned with AAP/API expectations

As part of this review, Hiring Managers must also reference the What NOT to Say During a Verbal Offer document. This resource outlines statements and topics that should be avoided during the verbal offer conversation to ensure compliance, avoid misunderstandings, and maintain a positive candidate experience.

These guidelines provide direction on:

- How to structure the conversation
- How to confirm interest
- How to communicate offer details
- What language to avoid

3. **Hiring Manager Contacts the Candidate**
   Before delivering the verbal offer, the Hiring Manager should first confirm that candidate's continued interest and availability.

**Step 1: Confirm Interest (First contact)**
Begin the call by checking whether the candidate is still actively interested in the position.

**If the candidate says *No*:**

- "Thank you for letting me know. May I ask what has changed since we last spoke?"
- Document the update and reason on BambooHR.

**If the candidate says *Yes*:**

- "Great! Before we move forward, I want to review the next steps in the hiring process."

Then remind the candidate of pre-employment requirements:

> *"As discussed during the interview, all new employees are required to complete a criminal background check and a pre-employment drug screen before employment is finalized. After HR contacts you, you will need to complete the drug screening within three (3) business days. Would you be able to meet this requirement?*

**Step 2: Extend the Verbal Offer**

Once continued interest and eligibility are confirmed, the Hiring Manager clearly communicates the verbal offer details, including:

- **Position title**
- **Salary or hourly rate**
- **Schedule/shift** expectations
- **Proposed start date**
- **High-level overview of benefits**
- **Any offer contingencies** (background check, drug screening, documentation, etc.)

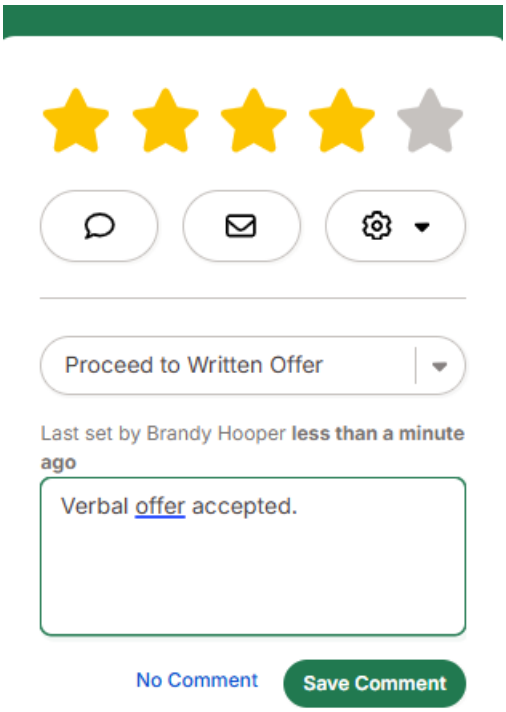
If the candidate needs time to consider the offer:

- In BambooHR, update the status to **Verbal Offer Made**
- Document the follow-up date and any details discussed

If the candidate verbally accepts immediately:

- Do **NOT** use "Verbal Offer Made"

- Update status to **Proceed to Written Offer** and comment “Verbal offer accepted” and **Save Comment.**




**Step 3: Written Offer (Formal Job Offer)**

**Hiring Manager Sends Offer Details to HR**

The Hiring Manager must send all required offer details to HR **using ONE of the two methods below**:

- **BambooHR Comment**
  - Update the candidate status to **Proceed to Written Offer**
  - Click **Add Comment (This step is REQUIRED to trigger HR’s notification email)**
  - Enter all required details

- **Email HR Directly**
  If unable to use BambooHR comments, Hiring Manager may email HR the offer details.

  - Update the candidate status to Proceed to Written Offer
  - Click **Add Comment (This step is required to trigger HR’s notification email).**
  - Enter “Will email details”

**Information that MUST be included (in comment OR email):**

- Candidate name & position (if emailing directly)
- Approved salary or hourly rate
- Proposed or confirmed start date
- Candidate’s preferred email and phone number
- Any negotiation notes or changes from the original job posting
- Any known contingencies (background check, drug screen, MVR if applicable, required certifications, etc.)

**HR Prepares the Written Offer**

HR reviews all details provided by the Hiring Manager and confirms:

- Pay aligns with approved pay band
- All contingencies are included
- Any exceptions have the required approvals

**HR Creates and Sends the Offer Letter**

- In BambooHR, update status to **Create Offer Letter**
- Generate the offer using the approved template
- Ensure contingent language is included (background, drug screen, MVR if required)
- Click **Send Offer Letter**
- BambooHR automatically updates candidate status to **Offer Sent**

**If the Candidate Does NOT Sign**

- HR follows up, if appropriate
- If the candidate declines:
    - Update status to Written Offer Rejected
    - Document reason in a Note

**If the Candidate Signs**

- BambooHR automatically updates status to **Offer Signed**
- HR receives automated notification and will forward to hiring manager
- HR updates status to **Hire**
- HR sets employment status to **Future Employee in Process**
- All candidate data flows into the new employee record for onboarding

➢ **Important Timing Notes**

Hiring Manager and HR should allow at least **10 business days** before the start date to accommodate:

1. Background check, MVR, and drug screen turnaround
2. Equipment ordering and shipping (for remote roles)
3. System access setup and onboarding scheduling